The Dhāraṇī called "Light Rays Entering from Every Side, Shining with the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa, Beholding the Heart and the Pledge of All Tathāgatas"

Samantamukhapraveśaraśmivimaloṣṇīṣaprabhāsasarvatathāgatahṛdayasamayavilokita-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 983 · Derge Kangyur

ཀུན་ནས་སངས་འཇུག་པའི་འོད་ཟེར་གཙུག་ཏོར་དྲི་མེད་པར་སྣང་བ་དེ་བཞིན་གཤེགས་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་སྙིང་པོ་དོང་དམ་ཚིག་ལ་རྣམ་པར་ལྟ་བ་བཞུགས་

The Dhāraṇī called "Light Rays Entering from Every Side, Shining with the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa, Beholding the Heart and the Pledge of All Tathāgatas," known in Sanskrit as the Samantamukhapraveśaraśmivimaloṣṇīṣaprabhāsasarvatathāgatahṛdayasamayavilokita nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Kun nas sgor 'jug pa'i 'od zer gtsug tor dri ma med par snang ba de bzhin gshegs pa thams cad kyi snying po dang dam tshig la rnam par lta ba, is a scripture centered on the recitation of a sacred formula, or dhāraṇī. It opens in the Tuṣita heaven, where the Buddha is surrounded by a great assembly of bodhisattvas and gods, including Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Śiva. There he teaches the six perfections, beginning with generosity and the merit that ripens from giving, as the setting for the dhāraṇī that is the heart of the work. It is Toh 983 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts, the class of short scriptures prized for their protective and purifying formulas.

In the language of India: samantamukhapraveśaraśmibimaloṣṇīṣabrabhās sarbatathāgatahṛdayasamayabilokitanāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī called "Light Rays Entering from Every Side, Shining with the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa, Beholding the Heart and the Pledge of All Tathāgatas."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

At that time the Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling in the divine abode of Tuṣita, together with a great saṅgha of bodhisattvas, a great host of attendant gods, and gods such as Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Maheśvara (Śiva). To the great assembly gathered there, the Blessed One taught the Dharma of the six perfections, namely:

the perfection of generosity, through which, by amassing a great accumulation of merit as the fruit of giving, one comes to the ripened fruit of a universal

monarch's power, a rain of the seven precious substances, and the arising of great treasures that appear spontaneously;

the perfection of moral discipline, which ripens as the fruit of meeting the teaching of the Tathāgata, the five superknowledges, being endowed with moral discipline, becoming Brahmā, and being born as a god;

the perfection of patience, which ripens as the fruit of a divine form that is desirable, beautifully adorned with the excellent major and minor marks, which one never tires of beholding;

the perfection of diligence, in which the undertaking of diligence ripens as the fruit of subduing Māra, liberation from aging, death, and birth, and going to buddha fields where one is born miraculously;

the perfection of meditative concentration, which ripens as the fruit of attaining many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of samādhis, beginning with the samādhi of heroic progress;

and the perfection of wisdom, which ripens as the fruit of a great accumulation of wisdom and gnosis, the amassing of an ocean of learning, and great erudition.

Then those sons of the gods contemplated and practiced this very Dharma door of the six perfections day and night, and, because it was so very hard, they also meditated upon it.

Now, within that same divine assembly there was a son of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three called Stainless Jewel Essence. He had a following of a thousand ten-millions of sons of the gods, was accompanied by eighteen thousand goddesses, and was surrounded by eighteen thousand goddesses. He possessed a celestial palace magically created by the gods, a mansion whose walls were built of the seven precious substances, beautifully adorned with all kinds of pleasure groves and with pools made lovely by divine flowers. That son of the gods, Stainless Jewel Essence, together with the foremost of the goddesses, called Endowed with Blossoming Flowers, was filled with great delight and attached to the bliss of the gods. Inside the mansion with its four doors made of the seven precious substances, abounding in the five qualities of sensual pleasure, intoxicated, swollen with pride and haughty, he lay down.

Then, at about midnight, that son of the gods fell asleep, and the whole host of goddesses also lay down in silence.

Then a chief of the divine yakṣas called Ulkāmukha, who dwelt in that excellent abode, roused that son of the gods, Stainless Jewel Essence: "O Stainless Jewel Essence, get up, get up! What is the use of your delighting in sleep and clinging to it? What is the use of making a habit of pleasure and dwelling in attachment? What is the use of enjoying the immeasurable riches of the gods? Seven days from now you will die. If you are to be parted from the riches of the gods and experience great feelings of suffering, what need have you of your abode, this excellent celestial palace made of the seven precious substances?

Your life now hangs between being and not being;
quickly ponder some means!"

Having spoken thus, Ulkāmukha, chief of the divine yakṣas, vanished.

Then, when the son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence had heard those harsh words, he fainted and fell from his couch face down onto the ground. And the hosts of goddesses tore their hair, their ornaments fell away, and their garments slipped loose. Blood and saliva ran from their mouths, and their lips, palates, throats, and tongues went dry. Uttering many thousands of laments, they wept and wailed, crying out, "Alas, alas!" From divine jeweled vessels they sprinkled perfumed water and cool sandalwood water over him. Some clasped him by the neck, some by the hands, some kissed his hair, some held him by the feet, and some held his head. Some fainted and fell down. Some writhed on the ground like fish out of water. Some rolled about as if their bodies were being burned by fire. Some, uttering many laments, cried out, "Alas, alas!" and wept.

Then the son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence came to from his faint and regained his senses. Vomiting blood from his mouth and experiencing great and violent suffering, he heaved a long sigh. His body trembled and shook like a tree struck by the force of the wind. With a hushed heart he hurried, hurried off to where Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, was. When he arrived, he touched his head to the feet of Śakra, lord of the gods, clasped both his feet, and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, please protect me! Blessed One, great-souled king of the gods, please protect me! I have heard the pronouncement of Ulkāmukha, chief of the divine yakṣas, who says that I will die in seven days, and who says, 'Consider the feelings of the beings in hell!' Lord of the gods, please tell me a fearless remedy, a means by which I shall not come under the power of the

Lord of Death and shall not go to the lower realms. Lord of the gods, by whatever means, please protect me with what will free me from the gate of the Lord of Death!"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, having heard these words, his heart deeply pained, spoke these words to the son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence:

"Son of the gods, do not be afraid! There is one by whom the Lord of Death will be defeated and beings will be freed from the sufferings of hell: the Buddha, the Blessed One, the Teacher of gods and humans in the world, the unsurpassed physician who has gone beyond birth, aging, sickness, death, and sorrow. He is your refuge and your good support, your ally, like a father and a mother to you. He is the one who destroys all the lower realms, so let us go quickly to the place where that guide dwells."

Then, at dawn of that night, Śakra, lord of the gods, together with the son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence and many thousands of gods and goddesses, went to Tuṣita and came to where the Blessed One was. They bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circled him three times, and sat down before the Blessed One.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, spoke these words to the Blessed One in humble words: "Blessed One, Ulkāmukha, chief of the divine yakṣas, has roused this son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence, saying that on the seventh day this Stainless Jewel Essence will come under the power of the gate of the Lord of Death. Blessed One, what should be done about this?"

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, having heard the words of Śakra, lord of the gods, smiled. As he showed that smile, light rays of many colors came forth from his mouth, and those light rays illuminated the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds. That radiance of light illuminated the abodes of all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, rākṣasas, and bhūtas, and roused them. Having roused them, the light rays returned, circled the Blessed One three times, and entered the door of the Blessed One's mouth. As soon as they had entered, he spoke these words to Śakra, lord of the gods:

"Lord of the gods, listen to how this son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence will come to the terror of the gate of the Lord of Death on the seventh day. If he should die, he will experience extremely unbearable, great suffering, fierce feelings, the feelings of beings in hell.

"First, in the great city of Vārāṇasī, in the muck of a bamboo worker's cesspit, he will be born as a pig-headed piśāca woman, and in that cesspit he will eat excrement and urine. In that very cesspit dwell a hundred thousand koṭis of creatures, and three times a day they will eat the flesh of that sow, leaving nothing but a skeleton. Then, by the power of karma, the body will become whole again, and he will live for seven years.

"Then he will die, and he will then be born in a wilderness as a turtle, in a place where even the name of water is never heard and there is no shade of trees. His body will be scorched by the heat of the sun, he will eat burning sand, and crows will peck at his body until it falls to pieces. Then, by the power of karma, the body will arise again and be destroyed again, and so it will be for a full five years.

"Then he will die and be born as a great fish in a great river in that same Vārāṇasī. Then, by the power of karma, he will be cast up where there is no water, and that great body will be eaten by venomous snakes, crows, wildcats, dogs, leopards, bears, jackals, and the like. Various other creatures will eat it too. Then, by the power of karma, the body will arise again and be consumed, and so it will be for three years.

"Then, having died once more, he will be born in seven households and experience the sufferings of Jambudvīpa: he will be born in the household of a leper, the household of a pauper, the household of a menial, the household of a butcher, the household of a low caste, the household of a caṇḍāla, and the household of a blind man, and he will experience suffering for sixty years. Having experienced those sufferings, he will then die and pass on, and he will experience suffering in the sixteen great hells for eighty-four eons. Lord of the gods, such great suffering is what he will experience.

"Even if by chance he obtains a human body, he will be poor, lacking limbs, of little wisdom, and illiterate; he will be separated from the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, despised by the whole world, always thirsty and tormented by hunger, short-lived, and much afflicted by disease."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, having heard this evil news about the son of the gods Stainless Jewel Essence, was utterly terrified before the Blessed One, and in dismay he spoke these words: "Blessed One, I have become without hope. There is no one to give me refuge."

The Blessed One said: "Lord of the gods, there is a remedy for the great punishment of the Lord of Death, and therefore do not be without hope!

Through it, in later lives and in later times, those beings, when the time of death comes, will die in peace. They will be freed from the hells and from all births as animals. Merely by remembering it, all obscurations will be purified. They will become long-lived. They will obtain a perfectly pure body."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Maheśvara bowed with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was, and spoke these words to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, please make our hopes grow. Blessed One, please protect all the gods. Blessed One, please free the whole world of beings. Blessed One, please calm the fear of death. Blessed One, please dispel the unbearable suffering of the beings in the hells. Blessed One, please summon Yama, the King of Dharma. Blessed One, please bring relief to the beings of the world-system of the four continents. Blessed One, please look upon the abode of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Blessed One, please seal the world-systems of the ten directions with the great mudrā of the wisdom of the tathāgatas of all ten directions. Please bless them with the blessing of the Tathāgata. Blessed One, out of love for us, please explain the great teaching that reveals the remedy. Sugata, please explain it."

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, understood what had been asked of him in these words, and he entered the meditative absorption called Seeing in Every Way. As soon as he had entered that absorption, a ray of light called Every Way came forth from the center of his uṣṇīṣa. It lit up every direction and stayed in the sky like a jeweled parasol. The Blessed One smiled, looked, and said to Śakra, lord of the gods:

"Lord of the gods, take up the dhāraṇī-mantra called the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa Illuminating with Light Rays that Enter All Gates, Beholding the Heart and Commitments of All Tathāgatas. This mudrā has been spoken and rejoiced in by tathāgatas as many as the grains of sand in sixty-two hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of Ganges rivers. Merely by seeing or hearing this dhāraṇī-mantra, one will be completely freed from misdeeds, from obscurations, from the hells, from the animal realm, and from all the fears of the lower realms. All the obscurations of past karma will also be destroyed, and all the hells will be destroyed as well.

Just as fire burns up grass
And the wind swiftly drives off the ash,
So too it burns all the misdeeds

Gathered in former lives.
Just as, when rain falls,
The torrents that run down the mountains
Sweep away all the rubbish
And all the mire on the ground,
So too, merely by seeing
Or hearing this dhāraṇī, misdeeds are cleansed.
Just as gold refined by fire
Grows soft enough to cut with the teeth,
So too, merely by reciting it,
The body is purified, without doubt.
Just as, when the sun has risen,
Its rays spread out everywhere,
So too whoever holds the dhāraṇī,
That person's body becomes beautiful.
Just as a fish flopping on dry land,
Parted from water, nears the door of death,
But when someone throws it back into the water,
Lives there and plays once more,
So too, merely by keeping it in mind,
People turn their lives back from death.

Lord of the gods, listen as I teach the dhāraṇī-mantra:

namaḥ sarva tathāgatānāṃ oṃ mahācintāmaṇi jvalana sāgara gambhire ākarṣaya ākarṣaya āyundhara āyundhara sandhara sandhara kṣaṇa kṣaṇa kṣiṇi kṣiṇi kṣuṇu kṣuṇu sarva tathāgata mahāsamaya tiṣṭha tiṣṭha mahābhuvana sāgara saṃśodhaya māṃ sarvasatvāṃśca bhagavati sarvapāpaṃ vimala jaya jaya jayalabdhe sphuṭa sphuṭa sphoṭaya sphoṭaya vigata āvaraṇi bhayaharaṇi hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ mṛtyudaṇḍadhare abhayaprade uṣṇīṣa vyavalokite samantamukhe samanta vyavalokite mahāmāye mahāvāśadhara amogha vimale ākarṣiya ākarṣaya ākaṇḍhaya ākaḍḍhaya bhara bhara saṃbhara saṃbhara indriya viśodhani bhūṣita bhūje mahāmudrā vilokite jaya jaya siddhe siddhe buddha buddha bodhani bodhani saṃbodhani saṃbodhani śodhani śodhani saṃśodhani saṃśodhani viśodhani viśodhanaṃ hara hara mama sarvapāpaṃ sarva tathāgata kulabhuje samaya tiṣṭhe prasaratu mama puṇye vinśyantu pāpaṃ sarva kilbiṣa hare maṇi viśuddhe śodhaya vimala vikāsita padme kavacita bhuje ṣaṭvāramitā parivūraṇi sarva

tathāgatoṣṇīṣa vilokite svāhā sarva tathāgata guhya adhiṣṣāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā āyurdade svāhā puṇyadade svāhā puṇya pilokite svāhāṃ puṇya avalokite svāhā mṛtyudaṇḍe svāhā yamdaṇḍe svāhā yamadūte svāhā saṃharaṇi svāhā saṃbharaṇi svāhā sandharaṇi svāhā pratisaraṇi svāhā tejovati svāhā tejovati svāhā jayavati svāhā sarva tathāgata mudrā adhiṣṣāna abhiṣṣīte svāhā

Lord of the gods, teach this dhāraṇī-mantra to the god Stainless Jewel Essence. Through it you will bring that god benefit and happiness for a long time.

This dhāraṇī-mantra, the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa Illuminating with Light Rays that Enter All Gates, Beholding the Heart and Commitments of All Tathāgatas, should be written down and placed inside a stūpa. The stūpa may be a new one or an old one that has been restored; it should be placed inside it. One should also offer incense and scented ointment, recollect the vidyā-mantra of the dhāraṇī one hundred and eight times, and meditate on it one hundred and eight times. In a single day and night one should recollect it three times by day and three times by night. Then, at sunrise, facing east, one should make a maṇḍala of fragrant substances and scatter flowers toward the sun. One should perfume it with the incense of aloeswood and turuṣka, pay homage to all the tathāgatas, and recite it one hundred and eight times.

If one builds one hundred and eight stūpas, writes this heart of the vidyā-mantra, places it inside the stūpas, and sets them upon the maṇḍala, then the bodily remains and relics of tathāgatas as many as the grains of sand in ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of Ganges rivers will have been placed inside each and every stūpa. It also becomes the very heart of the relics. This heart should be written down and placed inside."

oṃ namastraiyadhvikānāṃ sarvatathāgatahṛdayakarbhi jvala jvala dharmadhātugarbhe saṃbhara mama āyuḥ saṃśodhaya mama sarvapābaṃ sarvatathāgatasamantoṣṭīṣavimalaviśuddhe hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ aṃ baṃ saṃ jaḥ svāhā

If one shows reverence to this essence of all the tathāgatas of the three times, called the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa Illuminating with Light Rays that Enter All Gates, and performs the stupa rite, then even when one's life has run out, it is drawn back again, and one is refined into long life. And if one does die and pass on, one casts off the body as a snake sheds its skin, and goes, among those of equal fortune, to the world Sukhāvatī. One will not experience the suffering of death. From then on one will never again encounter the feeling of death. From

then on one will not go to or be born among the hell beings, the animals, the world of Yama, or the lower destinies. From then on not even the cries of the hell beings will reach one's ears, so what need is there to speak of experiencing their karmic ripening? That cannot happen.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, received this vidyā-mantra from the Blessed One (the Buddha), and at daybreak went with the god's son Stainless Jewel Essence to his own abode. Following the instruction the Tathāgata had given, he performed the stupa rite according to the ritual, step by step, and also performed the rite of recitation. As soon as it was done, all the sufferings of the god's son Stainless Jewel Essence were stilled, and he was freed from all his evil deeds. His body was purified, and the color of his skin became like gold. His hair and eyes became like sapphire. He saw all the tathāgatas directly before him, and from the expanse of the sky the tathāgatas uttered the words, "Excellent! Excellent!"

Then that god's son, seeing that he had come to have a body free of obscurations, was filled with great wonder and overjoyed, and he uttered this exclamation: "Alala, the Buddha! Alala, the vidyā-mantra! Alala, the Dharma! Homage, homage to the Teacher who shows the fruit at once, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, supreme in great compassion, like a wish-fulfilling jewel!"

Then that god's son went to his own abode and took divine flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands and various unguents, and took divine garments, adornments and ornaments as well. Together with all his retinue, the goddesses, the hosts of gods, Śakra the lord of the gods and the others, he went to Tuṣita. Having come to where the Blessed One was, he made a great offering to the Blessed One, circumambulated him a hundred thousand times, and sat there before the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma.

Then the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara (Śiva), and the great yakṣa general Vajrapāṇi bowed with joined palms toward the Blessed One and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, from what source and by what cause did such unbearable and fiercely burning karmic ripenings come upon the god's son Stainless Jewel Essence?"

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent, noble men! Noble men, you have asked well. Therefore listen, and I shall explain.

"Vajrapāṇi, long ago, in times past, in the southern region there was a city called Vast Coil. In it lived a brahmin called Vimala, learned, quick-witted,

clear-minded and sincere, handsome and beautiful, lovely to behold, of fine and radiant complexion, endowed with excellence, endowed with faith, of virtuous intention, a proponent of learning. He contemplated and meditated much on this queen of vidyās, wishing to benefit all sentient beings.

"In that same city there lived a householder called Prabhāsa, rich, of great wealth and great possessions, with many servants. That householder had no faith, and had faith instead in the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). Although the brahmin proclaimed this queen of vidyās together with its essence to the householder again and again, the householder did not give rise to faith in it. Instead he thought, 'I will chop this brahmin into pieces, throw him away like roasted fish and turtles, and fill his foul mouth with vomit.' The moment he had thought this, the householder was struck by leukoderma and leprosy.

"Then he died, and at the moment of death he experienced great painful feeling. Having died, he was born in the great hell Avīci, and there he experienced painful feeling for the length of an eon. Then, dying and passing on from there, he experienced suffering for an eon among fish, pigs and turtles. Then he died and was born in the hell Kālasūtra, the Black Line, and there too he experienced great suffering for the length of an eon. Then, dying and passing on from there, he was born in that same city into a family of blind people, and he became blind. As he went begging here and there, he came to a monastery, and in it there lived a monk who abided in compassion. That monk saw him, pervaded him with loving-kindness, and gave him food. He also proclaimed this queen of vidyās. When the blind man heard this dhāraṇī-mantra, he came to remember his former lives and remembered the brahmin too. Reflecting on it, he thought, 'Alas! I committed an unbearable deed!' and he was filled with shame and remorse. When he died, by the power of this dhāraṇī-mantra he was born among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and in a great palace, surrounded by a host of goddesses, he came to enjoy great divine pleasures.

"If you should doubt, wonder or be in two minds, thinking that the householder who became blind at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so. He is this very god's son, Stainless Jewel Essence. Vajrapāṇi, therefore one should be restrained by the three vows.

Vajrapāṇi, as the ripened result of that karma, he experienced feelings of suffering such as these. Until he reaches the very heart of awakening, this god's son will experience this, the last result of that karma.

Vajrapāṇi, if you suspect, or are in doubt or uncertainty, that the one who was the brahmin Vimala at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not see it that way: Vajrapāṇi, it was you yourself. The monk who proclaimed this dhāraṇī-mantra to the blind man is this very Mañjuśrī, the youthful one; at that time, on that occasion, he was a monk.

Then that great assembly of gods, having heard this account of the past, was amazed and filled with joy. Raising a great clamor and sound of laughter, they uttered this inspired utterance: "Alala! The power of this vidyā-mantra, the samaya of the tathāgatas, is like a precious wish-fulfilling jewel!"

Then from that assembly twelve thousand gods' sons became irreversible. A hundred thousand koṭis of gods' daughters were freed of the female organ, the male organ appeared, and they abode in irreversibility.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, these dhāraṇī words, this queen of vidyā-mantras, are of great power and great benefit. Blessed One, please explain the rite of practice by which, in later times, in a later age, beings will have benefit and happiness, and by which beings will be completely freed from the hells and from birth as animals."

The Blessed One said: "Vajrapāṇi, listen to the benefits of this dhāraṇī-mantra and to this rite of practice. In later times, in a later age, a son of good family or a daughter of good family, a monk or a nun, a layman or a laywoman should call this queen of vidyā-mantras to mind at a single time. One should circumambulate a relic essence, or a stupa containing the relic essence of a tathāgata. One should also call these two precious wish-fulfilling jewels to mind at a single time. By this, one will generate roots of virtue in the presence of as many tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in a hundred thousand trillion Ganges rivers. One will be endowed with great merit. Even the karmic obscurations of the five deeds of immediate retribution will be fully purified. One will be completely liberated from the lower realms: the hells, birth as an animal, and the world of Yama. One will live long. Casting off the body as a snake sheds its skin, one will go, by sharing in the same good fortune, to the world realm of Sukhāvatī. From then on one will not be sullied by the impurities of the womb. Wherever one is born, there one will be born miraculously, born from a lotus. In all lifetimes one will remember one's past lives. One will always long to behold all the tathāgatas. All one's wishes will be fulfilled just as one desires.

"If one wishes to perform the rite, one should bathe, put on new clothes, and make a square maṇḍala of fragrant substances. The heart vidyā-mantra should be written on birch bark. Five stupas should be erected, and this vidyā-mantra should be placed inside the stupas. Four stupas are placed at the four corners; one is placed in the center of the maṇḍala. Sticks should be planted and red banners hung from them. Flowers are strewn. Five full vases are set out. At the four corners, from four bowls, one should fumigate with incense of turuṣka, aloeswood, sandalwood, and guggulu. Four vessels of scented water for offering should be set out. These two precious wish-fulfilling jewels should also be recited one hundred and eight times. Reciting the heart mantra, one should circumambulate the maṇḍala one hundred and eight times. Those stricken by illness, those afflicted by harm, the gravely ill, those whose lifespan is exhausted, those in fear of untimely death, those terrified by kings or by hostile armies, and those who wish for a son are placed facing the maṇḍala. They should be brushed with five peacock feathers. The maṇḍala of stupas should be worshipped.

"If this rite is performed even once, one will be freed from the karmic obscurations accumulated over aeons and become free of obscuration. One will be completely liberated from all illnesses, all afflictions, all the lower realms of the hells, of birth as an animal and of the world of Yama, and from all fears. All worldly and transworldly sufferings, obscurations, misdeeds, and malice will be destroyed, from one lifetime to the next in succession, until one reaches the very heart of awakening. Even an exhausted lifespan will be extended, and one will live long. Even one wasted away by long illness, whose flesh is spent, will become whole in body. The body will become utterly pure. One's wishes will be fulfilled just as one desires. From then on one will not see the suffering of the door of the Lord of Death. Casting off the body as a snake sheds its skin, one will go, by sharing in the same good fortune, to the world realm of Sukhāvatī. Wherever one is born, there one will be born from a lotus. Everywhere one will be adorned with every ornament. In all births one will remember one's past lives.

"If, following the recitation rite for this, one recites it twenty-one times at the three times of each day, one will be completely freed from the obscurations of misdeeds and from all afflictions. If one carries out the recitation rite for one full year, one will attain the samādhi called Fearless Gaze, Light Rays of the Universal Door. In all the buddha fields of the ten directions one will see all the tathāgatas. One will attain the completely purified body called Stainless,

Utterly Pure, Blazing Splendor. One will attain a purified lifespan. One will generate roots of virtue in the presence of as many tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in eighty-two hundred thousand koṭi trillion Ganges rivers. Through the successive lifetimes, from one to the next, one will be utterly pure. To whatever buddha field one wishes to go, there one will go."

As a snake sheds its skin, they cast off the body, and because their fortune is the same, they are born in the world Sukhāvatī. They do not see the door of the Lord of Death, and they know everything to be like a dream.

On the eighth, the fourteenth, or the fifteenth day of the month, if one recites these two dhāraṇī-mantras of the great precious wish-fulfilling jewel one hundred and eight times and circumambulates a stūpa containing relics, then by the mere recitation a sound will at once come from the stūpa, granting the words "Excellent!" At once one will be free of the obscurations of wrongdoing, of all the afflictions, of the stains of attachment, aversion, and delusion, and of avarice and envy. One's body will become stainless and completely pure. Every man, woman, boy, or girl with whom one converses will also be freed from their wrongdoings. Even if one speaks to one who has gone to birth as an animal, it will be completely liberated from everything belonging to birth as an animal. Even if one speaks to any flock of birds, every flock of birds will be completely freed. Even if one speaks to dogs, tortoises, snakes, cats, weasels, and creatures of every kind, all of them will be completely freed.

If one recites it twenty-one times over sand and scatters the sand in a charnel ground, then those whose bones it strikes, in whatever hell they have been born, will be completely liberated from there and will be born in the heavens. Upon the bodies of those born in the heavens a rain of flowers will fall. All the wild beasts and the various birds that go to that charnel ground will also go to the happy destinies. If one scatters it on a mountain, all the deer and the birds that roam there will go to the happy destinies.

If one recites a hundred thousand times the essence of the tathāgatas of the three times, the Stainless Uṣṇīṣa Illuminating with Light Rays that Enter All Gates, then even those who have committed the five acts of immediate retribution and have fallen into Avīci, where they are burned by torment, will at once be completely liberated. If one recites it a hundred thousand times, even one who is being led away with a rope tied around the neck will at once turn back from the abode of Yama and will be completely freed from that great terror. All the hells too will be pacified and destroyed; there is no doubt of this.

Even Yama, the King of Dharma, will regard himself as their servant. As on the path of meditative concentration, or as a snake sheds its skin, they cast off the body and go joyfully to the world Sukhāvatī. They will not see the suffering of the Lord of Death.

If one writes it a hundred thousand times and places it inside a stūpa, then once the count of a hundred thousand is reached, all the stūpas will blaze, and oneself too will blaze. One will certainly and at once become irreversible and will abide on the ten grounds. One will generate roots of virtue under as many blessed tathāgatas as there are grains of sand in ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of Ganges rivers, and will receive their prophecy. Then, if one places them inside a single great stūpa and raises its central pole, it is called the stūpa of the hundred thousand relic-essences of the tathāgatas of the three times. All who perform any acts toward it will also become irreversible and will fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Even those belonging to birth as animals, and the various other kinds of creatures that go there, will also become irreversible. If even those touched by its shadow are completely freed, what need is there to speak of those who perform many acts toward it? The qualities and benefits of this cannot be expressed.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara (Śiva), the gods dwelling in the abode of Tuṣita, the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three headed by Śakra (Indra), and the god Stainless Jewel Essence, all of them went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they circumambulated the Blessed One three times, bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, this dhāraṇī-mantra of great power is, like a precious wish-fulfilling jewel, hard to see and hard to hear. Blessed One, gathering together, we shall uphold this precious wish-fulfilling jewel in the future, in times to come. We shall spread it. We shall proclaim it to all sentient beings. We shall follow close behind the great being who holds it, and constantly, without interruption, we shall protect, shelter, and conceal that person. We shall look after that person as our own child."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, friends, excellent! Do just so. I entrust to you this queen of vidyā-mantras, the precious wish-fulfilling jewel."

Here ends the noble dhāraṇī called The Stainless Uṣṇīṣa Illuminating with Light Rays that Enter All Gates, Surveying the Essence and Commitment of All

Tathāgatas.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Śīlendrabodhi and the chief editor and translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The name of the god, Stainless Jewel Essence, and of the goddess, Endowed with Blossoming Flowers, are translated from the Tibetan, since their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. The yakṣa's name, literally "Meteor Face," is given as Ulkāmukha, its evident Sanskrit equivalent. The phrase rendered "a great host of attendant gods" uses an unusual Tibetan qualifier whose sense is uncertain. In his plea, the young god addresses Śakra himself as "Blessed One," a title used here of the king of the gods rather than of the Buddha.
• □□□□ in "the great punishment of the Lord of Death" is rendered by its ordinary sense "punishment" rather than the doctrinal "annihilation," since the context is the penalty of death and rebirth in hell.
• The phrase rendered "the great teaching that reveals the remedy" is literally "the great teacher (or teaching) of the antidote." The request is for a teaching that counters suffering and death. The number word khrag khrig is rendered "niyuta," the usual equivalent in such counts. The god's name "Stainless Jewel Essence" is kept in English as in the earlier pieces; the Sanskrit is probably Vimalamaṇigarbha, but this is unconfirmed.
• The city name □□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with a Sanskrit form and is translated by meaning as "Vast Coil." The householder's name □□□□□□ is rendered Prabhāsa, a probable but not certain reconstruction. The god's son's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is kept in the English rendering "Stainless Jewel Essence" used throughout this text's drafts. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ is somewhat unclear; it is taken as going to Sukhāvatī "among those of equal fortune." The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "from what source and by what cause."
• "Trillion" renders the Tibetan large numeral khrag khrig, whose exact value varies between sources. "Bowls" interprets the unusual word phog por as phor pa, bowls or cups. "The brahmin Vimala" renders bram ze dri ma med pa as a name, following this text's established rendering of the character. The names "Fearless Gaze, Light Rays of the Universal Door" and "Stainless, Utterly Pure, Blazing Splendor" are rendered literally, following the text's established forms.
• "Ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas" renders the stock numeral phrase bye ba khrag khrig 'bum phrag dgu bcu rtsa dgu (koṭi-niyuta-śatasahasra) and means simply an innumerable multitude. "As on the path of meditative concentration" renders a terse phrase whose exact image is uncertain. It seems to compare an easy passing from the body to the meditator's departure. "Stainless Jewel Essence" is a literal rendering of the god's name, kept as in the earlier pieces; its Sanskrit form (perhaps Vimalamaṇigarbha) is not confirmed.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please

consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.